

Minutes of Meeting of Sub-Committee on IGNOU ACPDM Course held virtually on 28th October, 2025 at 4:00 pm

Welcome and Introduction

At the outset, Shri Satyendra Nath Kalita, Director (Regulatory Affairs) of AIDA, welcomed all members to the meeting of the Sub-Committee constituted to review and suggest upgradation of the Advanced Certificate in Power Distribution Management (ACPDM) course offered by IGNOU. He emphasized that this initiative aims to enhance capacity building for DISCOM personnel by aligning academic programs with emerging technologies such as smart metering, digital platforms, and operational efficiency. He further highlighted that the Committee would review the existing course content and propose suitable modifications to make it more industry-relevant and academically robust.

Presentation by Shri Sanjay Agrawal, Professor, IGNOU

Mr. Sanjay Agrawal outlined a proposal to transition the existing Advanced Certificate in Power Distribution Management to a PG Certificate Course, where graduate engineer shall be the target audience. He suggested that the course could be further developed into a PG Diploma and an MBA by incorporating additional relevant courses. Agrawal emphasized the need for input on what content should be added or removed to facilitate this upgrade.

He further outlined the structure of two courses, focusing on the power distribution sector and energy management. He described the blocks and units of the courses and emphasized the importance of self-learning materials. The AIDA Secretariat asked for more detailed content, and Sanjay provided a link to the syllabus for the experts to review.

He emphasized that the IGNOU course is designed to accommodate working professionals, allowing them to study without needing to take leave. Jignesh Ray proposed adding IT components to the curriculum and emphasized the importance of practical training, suggesting that it could be scheduled biannually.

Discussions held:

Shri Jignesh T. Ray, GM (HR), GUVNL, shared GUVNL's experience in developing technician-level programs in collaboration with ITIs on renewable energy and green hydrogen. Jignesh Ray will convince management to schedule practical training sessions for participants twice a year. He also offered GUVNL's support in hosting field training through its DISCOM facilities.

Shri Arvind Bhatikar, CGM (T&S), MSEDCL Nashik, suggested that the revised course should include new modules on renewable integration, smart and net metering, tamper/theft detection through data analytics, digitization of network mapping, and latest CEA safety policies. He pointed out the significance of addressing tamper events and energy theft detection in relation to smart meters. Additionally, he mentioned the solarization of FIDR and the need for a chapter on safety issues due to rising accidents.

Shri Karn Pallav, BSES Rajdhani, recommended that the program provide a holistic techno-

commercial and regulatory understanding, as current industry certifications often focus narrowly on either technical or financial domains.

Shri Balaji Sivan, CESC agreed with the members' suggestions and proposed to share written feedback after internal discussions with his institute's faculty team.

Members also discussed the need for Committee members to review the existing course content and propose suitable modifications to make it more industry-relevant and academically robust.



(Satyendra Nath Kalita)

Convenor, AIDA Committee

List of the Participants:

Committee Member Present

1. Shri Satyendra Nath Kalita, Director (RA), AIDA
2. Shri Sanjay Agrawal, Professor, IGNOU
3. Shri Jignesh T. Ray, GM (HR), GUVNL
4. Shri Arvind Bhatikar, CGM T&S Nashik
5. Shri Balaji Sivan, CESC Ltd.
6. Shri Prasad Patki, BRPL

Others Presents

7. Shri Sudhir Kumar, AIDA
8. Ms. Garima Maurya, AIDA
9. Shri Karn Pallav, BRPL
10. Shri Ayush Anand, BRPL
11. Shri Ravi Malik, BRPL